

USER RESEARCH SURVEY REPORT

PrintSlot

A Campus Print Shop Platform

Prepared by Team ParaDox

Mobile Application Development Project Report

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1. Introduction

PrintSlot is a mobile application for print shops in the campus. A student uploads files from their phone, sets after reviewing the print options for each file, checks the price, then joins a live queue or books a pickup time. The job appears on the shop's screen and progresses through the transparent steps until it is ready. The student is updated throughout and receives feedback.

This report is on the survey we conducted prior to constructing the entire app. We were interested in testing our concept People First with Real People. We interviewed students, print shop owners, shop staff and one university interviewed a number of stakeholders to understand their current printing practices and what they would want from a PrintSlot application. We In June 2026, collected 21 responses over 4 days. The remainder of the report takes you through the rationale for building it, our questions and the responses we received. How their response affected our plan.

2. Motivation

On-campus printing takes a while and can be a bit stressful. You walk to the shop, wait in line and then explain your settings to an engaged member of staff. Colour in or write in black and white one or two sides, How many copies, Which pages? Errors are inevitable and you may only discover them when you pick up the wrong print and have to pay for it anyway.

We've all experienced this in exam week when it feels like the line is long and the clock is ticking. Being on the other side isn't easy either. Staff have a cluttered list of jobs in their minds, and assume that each will be completed on a certain date. It's ready and it can answer the same question from all the customers: "is mine done yet?" We believed that the majority of this could be sorted out with a basic app. However, we didn't want to take a guess at building on, so we found out what it is that truly irks people on both sides of the counter, ran a survey before writing more code.

2.1 Which problem it is solving

There are obvious points of pain with having something printed these days:

- During busy hours and even for minor jobs, customers wait at the counter.
- Prices are unknown before work begins; Surprises at pickup.
- Print options are not written down and the wrong settings are used, leading to a waste of paper.
- When the customer gives a file to the company to work on, the customer won't be able to know at what point the file will be ready.
- Staff may have many jobs to do which are not in a list and for which they will not easily be able to tell people when to come back.

PrintSlot puts the entire order on the phone. Information on files and print options is recorded in writing. The price is displayed before placing an order. The work has discernable phases, and the client is informed of when it is ready. The shop receives a list of jobs to be ordered rather than a pile of jobs.

2.2 Publishing plan

PrintSlot is built as a small set of connected parts, and each part has a clear home for release.

Part	Technology	Where it is published
Mobile app	React Native (Expo)	Expo EAS build, then TestFlight (iOS) and Play Store internal track (Android)
Backend API	NestJS	Hosted on Render
Database and auth	Supabase (PostgreSQL)	Managed Supabase project
File storage	Cloudinary	Cloud bucket with a 24-hour hold for unused uploads
Notifications	Expo Push	Sent to each registered device

We will release in stages instead of all at once:

1. A closed test with the team and a few classmates, built through Expo EAS.
2. A pilot at one campus shop, with at least one busy shop so the queue and ready-time features face real load.
3. A wider rollout to more shops once the pilot runs smoothly, then the public app stores.

The first version stays focused. Wallet top-ups are added by the admin only, payment by card is left out for now, and every screen works in both English and Bengali. We can grow from there once people are using it.

3. Benchmark

People already have ways to get things printed. To see where PrintSlot fits, we compared it with the three common options today.

Feature	Walk-in counter	Phone or Messenger	Generic cloud print	PrintSlot
Order from your phone	No	Partly	Yes	Yes
See price before ordering	No	No	Sometimes	Yes
Print options saved in writing	No	Weak	Yes	Yes
Live status and ready time	No	No	Rare	Yes
Skip the line or book a time	No	Partly	No	Yes
Made for local campus shops	Yes	Yes	No	Yes
Works in Bengali	Yes	Yes	No	Yes
Pay with cash or wallet	Cash	Cash	Card only	Cash or wallet

The walk-in counter is simple but offers no price, no tracking, and no way to skip the line. Phone and Messenger orders help a little, but settings get lost in chat and there is still no clear status. Generic cloud print services have good tools, yet they are built for big offices, need a card, and do not speak to small campus shops in Bengali. PrintSlot sits in the gap between them: the speed of an app with the local, cash-friendly feel that campus shops need.

4. Survey

We ran the survey to test our idea against real opinions before building more. The goal was to confirm the problem, rank the features people want, and catch anything we had missed.

We used an online form and shared it with students, local print shop owners, and shop staff around the campus. People answered on their own time, and we collected no names. We kept it short so more people would finish it. In the end we received 21 responses between 13 and 16 June 2026,

and the group covered both sides of the counter.

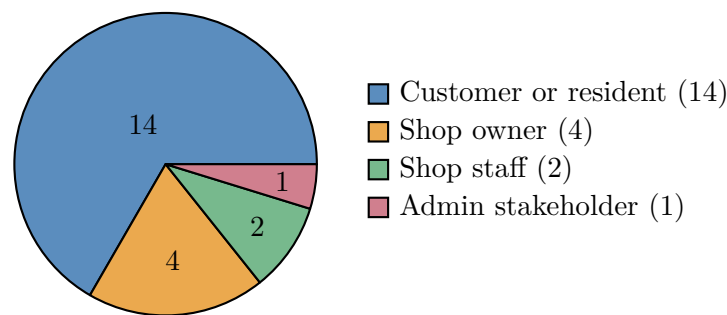


Figure 1. Who answered the survey (21 people).

Some questions were asked only to customers, such as payment choice, and some only to the shop side, such as daily order volume. The base for each result is written next to the chart so the numbers are easy to read.

4.1 Survey form (Google Form)

The survey was a Google Form titled *PrintSlot User Research Survey*. It opened with a one-line note on what PrintSlot is, then asked 15 questions. Most were multiple choice or checkbox questions so they were quick to answer, and a few were open text.

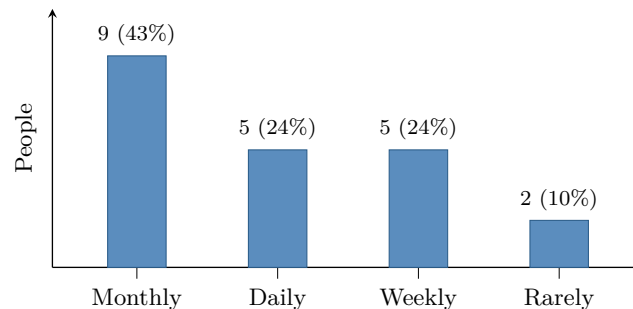
The first part asked your role and how often you print. The customer part covered the problems you face, the benefits you want, how you would order, how comfortable you are uploading files, how you would pay, the updates you want, and your main worry. The shop part asked about daily order volume, the hardest parts of the job, and the controls a shop needs before taking app orders. Two questions went to everyone: the preferred app language, and one open question, “What is one thing PrintSlot must do well for you to trust or use it?”

Form link: <https://docs.google.com/forms/d/e/1FAIpQLSe0lsf6EphH8ZfCpFw1DRVbFB9v2RuZKS18Sgc233Wq9ESm8g/viewform>. The raw responses are saved in *PrintSlot User Research Survey.csv*.

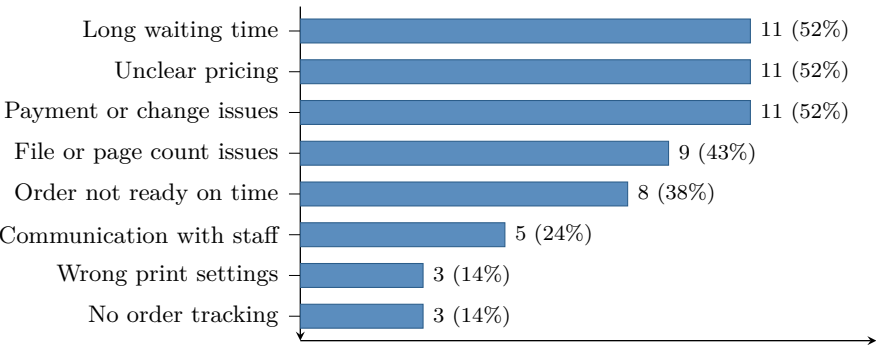
4.2 Results

The charts below show the survey results. For checkbox questions people could pick more than one option, so the shares add up to more than 100%.

How often people print (all 21)

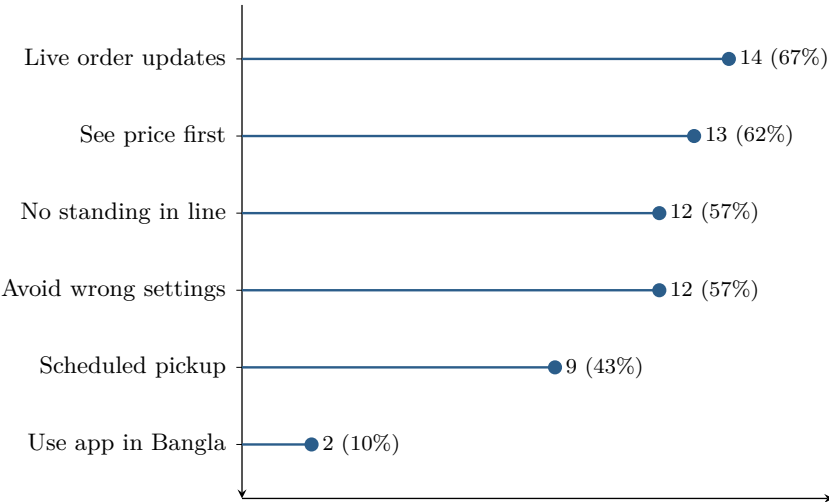


Problems seen in the last 30 days (all 21, pick many)

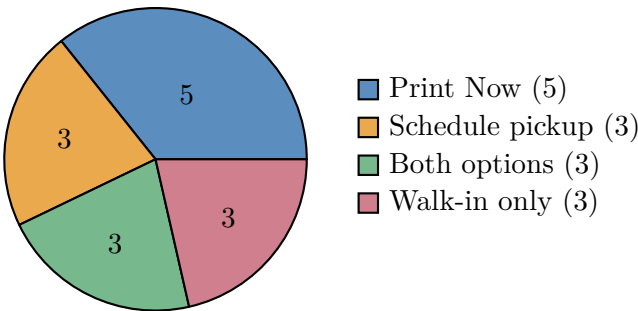


Most wanted benefits (all 21, pick three)

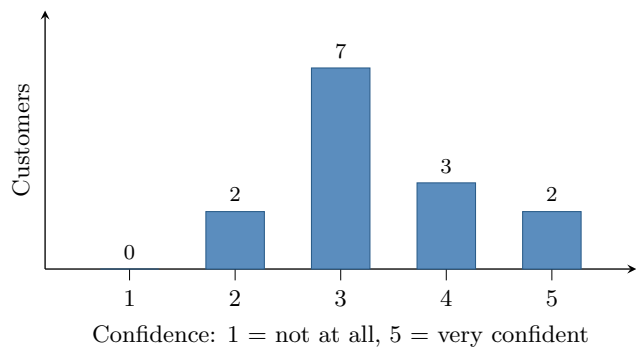
A lollipop chart keeps the ranking easy to read.



Order method customers would use (14 customers)

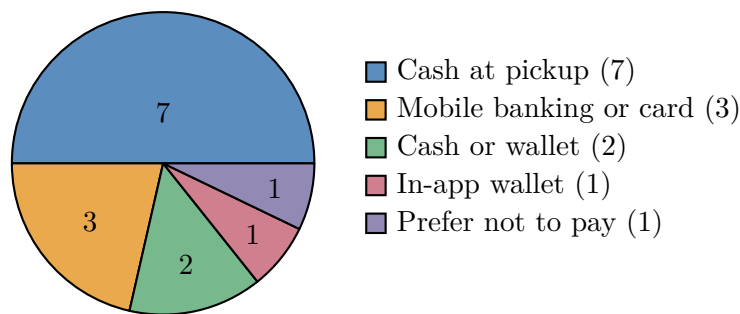


Comfort with uploading files and setting options (14 customers)



Average comfort score: 3.4 out of 5.

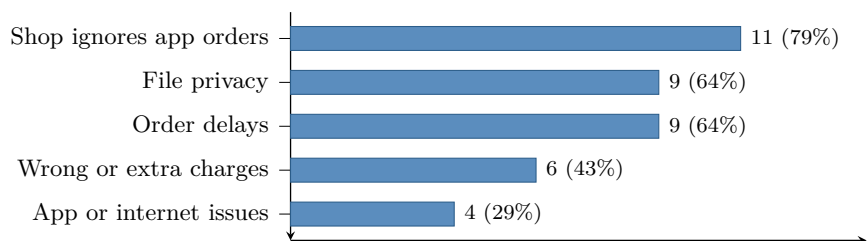
Preferred payment for campus printing (14 customers)



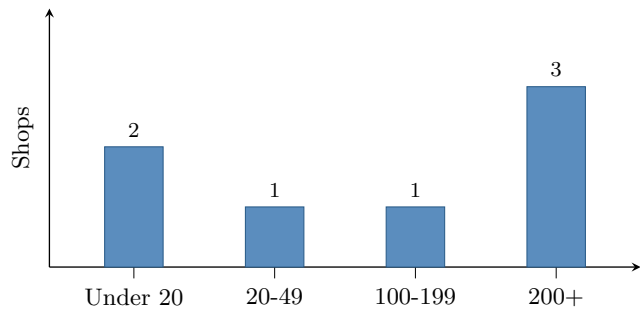
Updates customers want after ordering (14 customers, pick many)



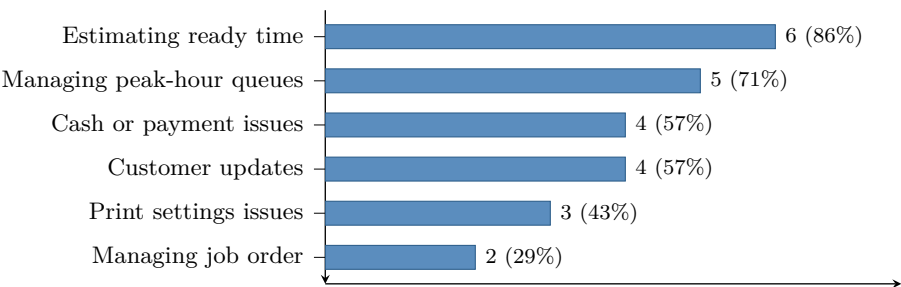
Biggest worry about using the app (14 customers, pick many)



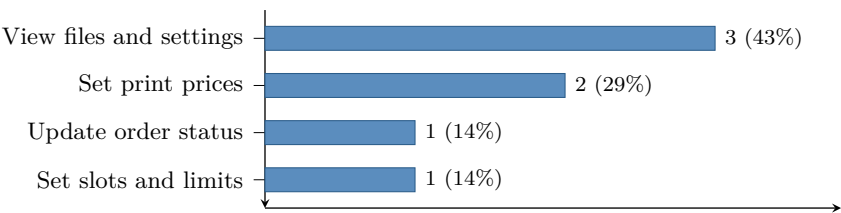
Daily order volume at the shop (7 shop-side answers)



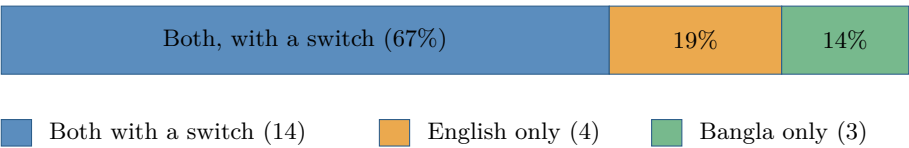
Hardest parts of managing jobs today (7 shop-side answers, pick many)



Controls a shop needs before taking app orders (7 shop-side answers)



Preferred app language (all 21)



In their own words

When asked what PrintSlot must do well to earn their trust, people gave short, clear answers. A few of them:

- “Accurate price and privacy”
- “Pricing should be fair”
- “Fast pickup”
- “The app UI should be user friendly”
- “Accurate pricing and easy settings”
- “Do the work perfectly”

The same points kept coming up: fair and correct pricing, file privacy, and a simple way to set the print options.

5. Analysis

The results back the core idea and also point out a few things we did not expect.

The main pains are real and shared

Long waits, unclear pricing, and payment or change problems each showed up in about half of all answers, at 52% each. Among the most wanted benefits, live order updates (67%), seeing the price first (62%), and skipping the line (57%) led the list. The problems people report line up almost exactly with the features we planned, which is the result we hoped for.

The biggest customer worry is being ignored

Key insight. Nearly 4 in 5 customers (79%) said their top worry is that the shop will ignore an app order. This beat file privacy and order delays, which were both at 64%. The fear is not the technology. It is whether the shop will treat an app order like a real one.

This changes how we think about the first impression. The app has to prove, fast, that the order reached a human and was accepted. A clear “order accepted” step, an instant alert to staff and owner, and a visible status are not nice extras here. They are what earns trust.

Shops struggle most with time estimates

On the shop side, estimating the ready time was the hardest part for 6 of 7 respondents (86%), and managing peak-hour queues followed at 71%. On the customer side, the estimated ready time was the most wanted update (64%). Both sides are asking for the same thing. A good, honest ready-time estimate is the feature that helps everyone at once.

Cash is still king

Half of customers prefer cash at pickup (50%). Only one person picked an in-app wallet as their first choice, and card or mobile banking drew 21%. This supports our plan to keep cash and a simple wallet for the first version and to leave card payments for later. We are not missing much by waiting on a payment gateway.

Comfort with the app is only fair

Comfort with uploading files and setting options averaged 3.4 out of 5, and half the customers sat right in the middle at 3. Nobody was fully lost, but few were fully confident either. The upload and options flow has to be very simple, with sensible defaults and clear labels, or these middle users will drop off.

Two languages, not one

Two out of three people (67%) want both English and Bengali with a switch. Add the three Bangla-only and four English-only voices, and almost everyone wants at least one of these languages done well. A working language switch is a must-have, not a polish item.

Walk-in is not dead

About a fifth of customers (21%) still prefer ordering at the counter, and high-volume shops with 200 or more orders a day make up 43% of the shop side. The app should add to the shop, not replace the counter. The pilot needs at least one busy shop so the queue and ready-time features face real pressure.

6. Updated project plan

Based on the survey, we are keeping the plan but changing the order of work and adding a few small things.

#	Change	Why (from the survey)
1	Make the “order accepted” step loud and clear, with an instant alert to staff and owner.	79% of customers fear the shop will ignore an app order.
2	Move the ready-time estimate up the build list and show it on the order screen.	Hardest shop task (86%) and most wanted customer update (64%).
3	Keep the price preview before ordering front and centre.	Unclear pricing is a top problem (52%); seeing the price first is a top benefit (62%).
4	Simplify the file upload and print-options flow, with defaults and a short first-time hint.	Comfort is only 3.4 out of 5; half of users are unsure.
5	Keep cash plus a simple wallet for v1; leave card payment for later.	50% prefer cash; only 7% want an in-app wallet first.
6	Add a short, plain note about file privacy and the 24-hour auto-delete of unused files.	File privacy is a worry for 64% of customers.
7	Treat the English and Bengali switch as a core feature, tested on every screen.	67% want both languages with a switch.
8	Pick at least one high-volume shop for the pilot.	43% of shops handle 200 or more orders a day; peak-hour load is a top pain (71%).

None of these need a new system. They are mostly about the order of work and clear messaging. The survey did not break our plan. It told us which parts to polish first.

7. Conclusion

The survey was effective. It made clear that the issues we were trying to address are indeed issues and plaguing both customers and shops. The features that people desire most are the ones that we were planning to create, which gives us confidence to keep going. The most obvious takeaway is to trust. No one will be afraid of the app itself. They will be afraid that they are not being listened to. Have been set up by the shop, overcharged, or left waiting for no reason. Thus, the initial version will say loudly thrice: the order accepted, the price right, and here is when it will be ready. If you do these right, in both languages, you’ve got a real shot at PrintSlot having a chance on campus.